Shanmukh Upadhyayula

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Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign GPA: 3.95/4.0

Master of Computer Science (MCS), Planned *August 2027 – May 2028*

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science & Geographic Information Science *August 2024 – May 2027*

- Involvement: ACM SIG Project Lead for HCI and AI, Virtual Reality Physics Simulation Developer
- Relevant Coursework: Data Structures, Algorithms & Models of Computation, Computer Systems, Database Management in the Cloud, Applied Linear Algebra, Spatial Analysis, Human-LLM Interaction

Experience

UIUC CyberGIS Lab Urbana, IL

Machine Learning Engineering Intern *September 2026 – Present*

- Testing and improving I-GUIDE's LLM geospatial agent, which writes and runs GIS code from plain-language requests
- Benchmarking the agent on GeoAnalystBench, finding it answers 48 of 50 tasks but over-plans on 43 of 48, and showing the benchmark's expert answers are too abstracted to fairly grade an LLM's step-by-step workflow
- Uncovering silent failures with trap datasets, like partial file reads and wrong CRS units causing a 10x area error

ACM SIG-CHI | github.com/sigchi-uiuc/digital-diary Urbana, IL

Project Lead *September 2025 – April 2026*

- Led a 15-person team building a Next.js journaling app that uses the Claude API, Google Calendar, and weather data
- Engineered a real-time OpenCV and MediaPipe pipeline that tracks face and hand landmarks for mood and gesture controls, deployed as its own Docker service

UIC Electronic Visualization Laboratory | github.com/ShanmukhUpad/curio Chicago, IL

Software Engineering Intern *June 2025 – August 2025*

- Cut processing time by about 30% across hundreds of Chicago urban data pipelines by building a Pandas merge tool
- Added dataset merging and multi-tab views to Curio, a TypeScript and Python web app for visual data pipelines

Projects

Multi-Region Cloud Web Service | *Node.js, Express, Python, GCP* | *Cloud Database Course Project* October 2026

- Deployed a Node.js and Express REST API on Firestore to Google Cloud servers in the US and Europe
- Quantified a 3 to 4 times slowdown in Europe by benchmarking latency in Python, since each request crossed the Atlantic twice, with 0 stale reads in 100 trials

Smash Ultimate Rankings Dashboard | shanmukhupad.github.io/Smash-Ultimate-Rankings September 2026

- Shipped an interactive dashboard comparing my ranking of all 89 fighters to the competitive tier list, with filters, bootstrap confidence intervals, and permutation tests
- Kept bad data out of the charts by writing unit tests for the statistics and build-time validation that fails the build on a bad edit, with seeded randomness for reproducible results

Codebase Mapper | *TypeScript, Next.js* | codebase-mapper.vercel.app July 2026

- Developed a live developer tool that turns any GitHub repo into an interactive dependency map, with import resolvers for over a dozen languages including Go, Java, Python, and C++
- Generated plain-language explanations of each file with the Claude API, caching them in the browser so every file is only explained once
- Helped developers grasp large codebases faster than browsing a file tree by mapping how every file connects in one interactive graph

Multi-Agent LLM Sycophancy | shanmukhupad.github.io/portfolio/mas.pdf March 2026 – May 2026

- Demonstrated that one injected false claim spreads to 100% of agents in a hierarchical LLM agentic workflow by turn 3
- Measured the failure without an LLM judge using stance flips, planning errors, and deference language, and co-authored an ACL-format paper on it

Technical Skills

Languages: Proficient in Python, Java, C++, SQL | Familiar with C, TypeScript, JavaScript, R
Frameworks: PyTorch, Pandas, NumPy, OpenCV, React, Next.js, Node.js, Express
Infrastructure & Tools: Git, Docker, Linux, Google Cloud, Firestore, MongoDB, GeoPandas